> It's very crystal clear Myanmar government is harassing, and it's very clear international community is giving pressure consistently … And it's very clear, as well, Myanmar government is not caring. And finally, it's very crystal clear that Rohingyas are suffering more and more, more and more each day. Finally, Myanmar government created such an environment, so that Rohingya will not enjoy—Rohingya could not stay over there, because their social, economic life was damaged. They are not allowed to move freely.
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> …
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> US government should give a warning to them. This diplomatic warning; it's not like war. They say, 'You have to do these things—enough is enough—within a time frame.' Very simple. We are not demanding anything. We are just demanding—what we need is not new thing, just to restore our previous rights. We just simply want to enjoy normal rights. And ethnic name is totally blocked for us. It's nothing concerned with the government. That's it. We want to be part of the union, we want to be the good citizen, and we want to have our better socioeconomic life, with simple living, with—starting with our own land. If Myanmar government deny, please make sanction, start with economic sanction again, which was lifted before by blah, blah, blah, because of this Aung San Suu Kyi.[16]

In this respect, it is clear that some Rohingyas believe that Western indulgence of Aung San Suu Kyi is feeding into the regime's overall belief that it will face no real pressure, and is thus steadily preparing the ground for the day when an attempt at mass expulsion of the Rohingyas may occur. Those who support the Rohingyas believe that in 1978 and 1994 there was a reduction in the level of persecution due to the economic weakness of the regime and some external pressure, specifically from the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation (OIC). This grouping has continued to support the Rohingyas and to call on the international community to meet its responsibilities.[17] But the regime now feels much stronger, with potentially tragic consequences: 'if the international community keeps supporting Myanmar country, if they become a bit stronger, my gosh, they will kill us like in Rwanda'.[18]

Past pressure from the OIC and other bodies is credited with forcing Myanmar to accept a partial return of refugees in 1978 and 1994 from Bangladesh and Malaysia. We have seen that pressure from the US and ASEAN has led Myanmar to take limited conciliatory steps. The evidence is that to the extent to which it has been attempted, international pressure has worked to alleviate conditions for the Rohingyas. This surely is a strong argument in favour of stepping up this pressure.

There are four main external players in Myanmar: the UN, the US, China and the ASEAN group. Each offers something different.